

Forgiving the Younger Self

50–55 min · October Week 2

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS

OBJECTIVE	Students apply the forgiveness/reconciliation distinction to themselves across time — distinguishing forgiving the younger self (releasing the self-resentment that has accumulated) from reconciling with who they were (not required), and naming the specific weight they have been carrying about their own past.
DURATION	50–55 min · October Week 2
KEY VOCABULARY	forgiving the younger self · self-resentment · self-directed forgiveness · temporal self · shame vs. guilt · grief vs. resentment · intergenerational shame
OPENING REVIEW	'Last lesson: the living amend — the adult form of accountability. Today: what do you do with the version of yourself who needed that amend? Can you forgive them?'

★ PPRA — COUNSELOR AWARENESS REQUIRED

★ PPRA-designated. Psychological self-examination of self-directed resentment, shame, and self-forgiveness. Counselor on standby same day. **CRITICAL DISTINCTION — GRIEF vs. RESENTMENT:** Many students confuse the grief they feel about the past with resentment toward their past self. These require different tools. Name the distinction explicitly in Step 2. Releasing grief is a different process from releasing self-resentment — and confusing the two produces shame spirals when the grief does not respond to forgiveness techniques.

ANCHOR CHART

FORGIVING THE YOUNGER SELF — THE TEMPORAL DIMENSION THE YOUNGER SELF: The version of you who was younger, less developed, less equipped, operating with less information, fewer resources, and more fear. Not a different person — a prior version of the same person. **SELF-RESENTMENT:** The resentment directed toward your younger self. The contempt for who you were. The wish that you had known better sooner. **SELF-DIRECTED FORGIVENESS:** Releasing the self-resentment. Not pretending the past behavior was acceptable. Putting down the weight of carrying contempt for a version of yourself who was doing what they could with what they had. **THE GRIEF DISTINCTION:** Grief about the past is not the same as resentment toward the past self. Grief says: I wish things had been different. It is a response to loss. Resentment says: I blame that version of me. It is a response to perceived culpability. They require different tools. Forgiveness releases resentment. It does not dissolve grief. **POST:** Before class. **KEEP:** Unit 2.